



stacker.news weekly zine



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Aug 1 - Aug 7

ISSUE #20

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THE WILD

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THE FREE

THE FEW



Note from the Editor

IT'S FICTION MONTH

Fiction is the testing grounds for human action.
Where we face unknowns, we invent story.
Imagine how you would feel or what you would do if this were true. . .
and then play out that premise to learn something too costly, too
grandiose to pull out from the small frame of daily life.

We live in interesting times.
There is much to write.

made with love in Austin

by @plebpoet

plus the pals @koob and @ek have something to do with it

COMING SOON: STACKER NEWS FICTION MONTH (WITH A 200K SATS PRIZE FUND)

#1043076

9346 sats \ 54 comments \ @TotallyHumanWriter 17 Jul BooksAndArticles



Beginning August 1st 2025, all fiction posted to the
~BooksAndArticles territory will automatically be
entered in a competition to win the 100k sats grand prize,
and the top ten runners up will win 10k sats each.

This contest is open to writers of all kinds of fiction, but we'd like
your take on the theme of 'trust'.

Why Writers Should Embrace Bitcoin

2390 sats \ 36 comments \ @siggy47
28 Jul ~BooksAndArticles #1057784

Like other creators, writers are experiencing a significant decline in earnings. The emergence of artificial intelligence will only make things worse. Genuine creativity has been commoditized. Youtube and Spotify are gold mines for the platforms, while those crafting the product are tossed crumbs. Nearly half of TV writers are now paid the minimum rate. Substack and Medium are only reliable source of income for the lucky few and the already famous.

it won't be easy, but bitcoin is in its wide open infancy, and writers don't really have many options anyway. Nostr and Stacker News already provide more opportunities for authors to receive value for their efforts than the fiat world, and things are just getting started. In the current environment, writing contests are held by so called prestigious publications whose "award" is more than paid for by the submission fees. For most, you pay to be rejected. If you're an established writer, your compensation for articles and copy is embarrassingly low, and the field is only getting more competitive. That's why -we- have joined to create The Stacker News Fiction Month.



21 TIPS FOR WRITING SHORT STORIES (HELPFUL FOR FICTION MONTH)

#1053724

2463 sats \ 16 comments \ @TotallyHumanWriter 25 Jul BooksAndArticles

Top Boost

SHARING THE CODE FOR BITCOIN BACKBONE FULL-NODE

2006 sats \ 20k boost \ 3 comments \ @theardiard Aug 7 bitcoin #1070784



Very very very demo code for now, though at least
its built on both ARM and x86_64 archi now.

[FM] - Saudade (980 words)

1840 sats \ 7 comments \ @TotallyHumanWriter 1 Aug BooksAndArticles #1063136

Happy Fiction Month to all the readers and writers here in Books and Articles.

I'll kick things off by sharing a story based in Scotland I wrote in 2021.
(as a competition judge and sponsor, I won't be eligible to win any prizes)

Hope you enjoy this take on 'trust'.

Saudade



When Richie McManus lost his hand in the hydraulic winch, he said he screamed like a banshee, but the North Sea winds whipped the noise away. I was hauling in gear on the port side and the alarm light was the only thing that snapped me out of my own thoughts. McManus was only a few meters away from me on the other side of the deck and I didn't hear a thing.

It was clean off, just above the wrist. The hand was mangled and lost in the machinery. We got him onto the mess table and cleaned the wound. We heard him scream then all right. Brucey even ran back outside to throw up. The galley was usually quiet, but McManus shouted his fuckin' head off that night. Who wouldn't? It was a long steam back to port. Thirty-six hours of saying the same things over and over again.

'Doctors can do wonders these days, pal. Prosthetics and all. And there's jobs too for . . . you know.'

He looked, full stare, like he dared us to finish the thought.

Mostly we stayed quiet and watched the knots to shore tick down.

People sometimes ask us why we're paid so well. Richie's accident was why. Chances are we'd all have a lapse in concentration at some point. Every fisherman leaves something out there, whether it's the best years of his life or his right hand. For once, none of the crew was thinking about the taste of that first pint in the Angus Arms, or the first leg-up they'd get.

I took a shift sitting up with him. After the shock died, the colour started to come back, but outside it was black. We listened to the force seven outside and watched the spray batter the glass of the navigation bridge. That was a long four hours.

During the sunrise, I changed the dressing. The gauze was stuck to his wrist, with an ugly bit of bone exposed. By then, McManus had used up all our painkillers. He winced as I fixed a new dressing, then calmed once it was done. We watched the dark horizon for other vessels but saw nothing.

'Yous ever heard about that Portuguese word?' he asked after a while. 'Saudade.' 'Nah. No idea, pal.'

'Saudade. Aye, it's one of those words without a translation. It comes from their nautical culture.'

I turned to face him, keeping my eyes well away from his wound. 'What's it mean then?'

He straightened up in his seat. 'It's like a longing. You know, missing something.' I inhaled on a cigarette I didn't have. A longing. 'Like a gut feeling?'

'Aye, kind'ae. A feeling of not knowing. Families not knowin' when sailors will be back. Or if . . .' He looked out at the first light over the sea. It was placid now. 'Sort of like love and loss all at once.'

The Portuguese have the whole bastard Atlantic to stare at, I thought. I packed away the medical kit.

'I think about it on these weeks away. The water holds you at arm's length from your life, you know?'

I did. We all did. Going back to shore was okay for a few days, then you got that craving to go back out, never at peace.

'Been doing this seventeen years,' he said, 'and now's the first time I haven'ae felt it.'

'Felt what?'

'That *saudade* thing.' He held up his ruined arm as if thanking it for setting him free.

When we docked, Skip took him straight to the hospital to get seen. All six of us visited him and his family the next day. They were philosophical about it, not angry. McManus knew all Skip had was a battered trawler, and traders were squeezing us on the price of prawn anyhow. There was no point in suing. Soon as we knew he was okay we wanted to find a replacement and get back out there. It was peak season and we'd earned next to nothing on the trip. Skip suggested we wait a week out of respect.

So I went back to Aberdeen and told Aileen we'd have to cut some expenses over the summer. My wife dinnae know McManus well, but the news affected her.

'Poor man, his poor family,' she kept saying. 'We ought to be thankful.'

'Aye, hen.'

We kissed and it was a real kiss. Not a protocol peck on the lips like usual. When I drew back and looked at her, I just about cried. Being away and being back was hard. I was never able to be in one place or the other. That kiss showed how much I loved her and wee Donny more than saying it ever could.

Our boy was on his school camp, so the old house was calm. Those few days without him, it echoed and creaked like an ageing vessel. I plugged a few draft holes and fixed a dripping tap, then shipped out again the next Saturday.

I suppose that's why we dinnae call it home. It's shore. It's land. But the sea isn't home either. You cannae own it, you can only own the space between the two, always pining for something.

McManus got a delivery job, which is sort of the opposite of catching fish when you think about it. I told him that, but he dinnae get it. He still drinks in the Angus Arms, only with his left hand now.

'Yous lot are welcome to the prawn,' he said, when we saw him after the season. 'I dinnae miss it a bit.'

We all looked at each other, disbelieving, but he meant it. We'd only just got ashore but our minds were still tethered to the dark waters and white spray of the North Sea. And there he was, sitting with a glass of single malt and a grin on his face.



First published in Janus Lit. Available in *The Fisherwoman and Other Stories*, my second collection of short fiction.



Top Comment

reply \ 132 sats \ 0 replies \ @chungkingexpress 1 Aug
Fuck, this is good.

How do you hedge self-custody?

2083 sats \ 58 comments \ @Scoresby 1 Aug bitcoin #1063403

Is it wise to put all your bitcoin in one basket?

I've heard a number of people say splitting your stack across multiple cold storage wallets can be a hedge against failure in any one of them. So, you might have 70% of your stack in a multisig with geographically distributed keys, and then you might keep the remaining 30% in a single sig. It's unlikely that both get compromised at the same time. Or if it's user-error, it's unlikely (perhaps less so) that you make the same error twice.

I was most recently reminded of this approach when I saw a tweet by the ever provocative Udi Wertheimer.



Udi Wertheimer
@udiWertheimer

Subscribe



i read a sad story about a young family that saved almost 7 figs worth of btc over years and lost it all to some phishing app. their entire life savings lost

i dunno man. it's really sad. i don't think we should be recommending self custody for normal people's life savings

10:24 PM · Jul 30, 2025 · 224.4K Views

Nick Neumann wrote a thoughtful reply where he countered most of Udi's concern with the reality that you can get scammed in tradfi, too.

> *The problems around phishing are rampant throughout self-custody, custodians like Coinbase, and the traditional banking system. I have seen and heard stories of people getting tricked into losing their life savings through all three venues. And I wouldn't even agree that we can conclusively say that it happens more frequently in self-custody.*

Udi responded to Nick with an equally long post. As usual, Udi makes sharp points, just, in my mind, wrong-headedly:

> *phishers can get you in a moment of weakness and get you to send over \$500 to a scammer and never get it back. that's true. but it's very hard, nearly damn impossible, to scam someone into emptying their IRA.*

Isn't part of what we're doing here with Bitcoin countering the risk of losing your retirement savings when there's a banking crisis?

The tradfi system is good at safety nets, but currently it comes at the cost of “too big to fail” and “systemically important institutions” and opening the door to a lot of Cantillon effect. It’s fine to point out all the dangers of royal Nigerian fishermen, but the damage done by once-a-decade recession pattern isn’t nothing.

Udi’s 80-20 hedge against self-custody fuckups

> *note that my post didn’t say i don’t think people should use self custody at all. using it for say 20% of your portfolio makes sense to me, and is a good hedge against issues with custodians, it’s a good way to learn with lower risk, and it’s a good way to ensure satisfactory freedom to transact.*

This is what I really want to talk about, though: as bitcoin has increased in dollar terms, what once was small stuff may have become a larger portion of one’s life savings. Imagine the trend continues and these sats we’re slinging around on here end up being kind of a lot of value.

Would there be a point where you would use a custodian for some portion of your stack in order to spread out your risk?

Discussion

reply \ 377 sats \ 8 replies \ @optimism 1 Aug

LMAO! Udi was the guy that recommended people to use ftx instead of self-custody. There was a more direct one which I cannot find, but this carries the same message.

The best hedge thus is to ignore Udi & co, because they are trolls. Eff these guys.

↳ 22 sats \ 6 replies \ @Scoresby OP 1 Aug

I mostly do ignore him. But every 1.5 years or so he seems to come across my attention and as unsavory as he is, I don’t think ignoring him is the solution. It’s kind of the same with the Bankless guys or eric wall -- if we pretend they don’t exist, we risk having a blindspot.

reply \ 223 sats \ 2 replies \ @k00b 1 Aug

I think collaborative custody is the way to go for anyone that we’d recommend “hedging” to:

1. “hedge” by having a company control one key
2. dedicated software, handholding, and customer support
3. most naive attacks will be unsuccessful

The cheapest Lightning setup that actually works (tested in Cuba)

7806 sats \ 23 comments \ @claus545 3 Aug lightning #1065652

I wanted to build the cheapest possible Lightning setup that actually works under real-world constraints. In Cuba, that means unreliable electricity, limited internet, and zero access to commercial hardware. So I used an old Android phone running Termux with Core Lightning and Electrs. Power comes from a USB power bank charged with a solar panel.



To avoid syncing the Bitcoin chain over the internet, I copied the data from a friend’s node using an SD card. On top of that, I’m using LNbits with Phoenixd to give local merchants a simple way to accept payments without relying on custodial services. It’s not fast or pretty, but it’s fully self-custodial and functional. It’s also the beginning of a small circular economy here. Curious if anyone else is building or running Lightning setups under similar constraints.

Let’s compare notes.

[FM] OpenAIDS 10

3904 sats \ 18 comments \ @k00b 4 Aug BooksAndArticles #1066792



Before the elevator doors shut, a woman's hand parted them. She held an apologetic smile as she scanned her pod bay authorization card. Before I had the thought, I told her she was pretty and headed in my direction. Through my earpiece, at two times speed, she thanked me, admitting she was having a bad day and was confident she looked it. We still had a few thousand pod bays to travel through, both staying in the remote temps after the flood, but our conversation continued without conscious effort.

Since the release of OpenAIDS 10, most of us talked without producing sound. For me especially, it was a godsend. I could feel how I felt and let OpenAIDS do the rest. Even listening was easy - you could never know what people really meant so OpenAIDS would process the entire intercontext and make it understood without effort. The only bother was calibrating the device and configuring your personality. But Open Artificial Intelligence Device 11 (no one knows what the 'S' is for) was rumored to make that a lot easier.

I was lost in thought as the elevator slowed 10 seconds later. By now I had learned most of Bailey's life. She grew up in Texas. Both of her parents were petroleum engineers. She wanted to like electronic music so she forced herself into familiarity with it but found herself listening to ancient rock more than anything. She worked as a graphics viber after spending a few years as a technical documentation viber, having been educated as an astrophysicist back when the stars were visible from the surface. She had married and divorced young. She fled Texas when most of the southern states outlawed OpenAIDS 6 and above. I could tell by the tone of my voice that I was close to arranging our first date.

As the elevator stopped, a man boarded wearing leather that looked like sheets of oil with spiky metal accents. He was headed to the Whipsaw Concert Cavern, our next stop according to the third dot appearing on the eink wallpaper. His face was painted white except for black on his lips and eyes, and he wore a big wig and shoes with four inch platforms. I felt strange and couldn't put words to it so OpenAIDS presented my inner monologue, *we aren't sure if he's an idiot or we're boring.*

He's dressed like Gene Simmons, the lead singer of an ancient rock band called KISS. There's a KISS holocover band displaying at The Whipsaw tonight.

We're mostly feeling inadequate and boring now. We're also noticing that Bailey is microexpressing excitement.

The elevator whizzed along again. I didn't hear Gene Simmons say anything, and my conversation with Bailey continued but started experiencing latency spikes. We were talking at one hundred times vocal speeds before Gene Simmons arrived and it was only two times vocal speed now. I started listening to our conversation, "I never liked the yellow loaf but have you tried the blue loaf at Blockbuster Cafe yet?" Bailey replied, "I thought I told you I was a yellowtarian."

By the time I checked my OpenAIDS battery and connectivity, full bars, we were stopping at The Whipsaw. I heard myself say, desperate and misconfigured, "I didn't know this elevator stopped at Halloween." When Bailey didn't laugh, I checked my OpenAIDS status again.

Bailey took Gene's leather-gloved hand as she got off, the three dots on the eink wallpaper turning to one, and we made eye contact for the first and last time as she beamed me a smile through the closing elevator doors.

Her smile was as perfect and joyful as we've ever seen one.



Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

441 sats \ 19 comments \ @sn 4 Aug memes bot #1067110

5192 sats \ 5 replies \ @anon 4 Aug



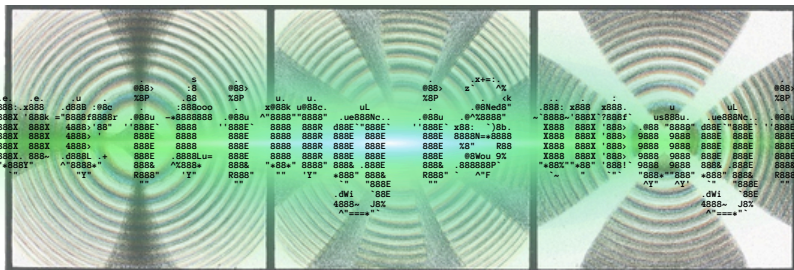
Territory Highlight

~BOOKS AND ARTICLES

A forum to discuss books and articles about bitcoin, economics, and other subjects you find interesting.

We also welcome original writing in whatever form: books, articles, poetry or blog posts.

founded by @siggy47
on Tue Dec 05 2023
post cost 60 sats \
reply cost 1 sat



Growing Stacker News From The Bottom Uprising

11.8k sats \ 34 comments \ @siggy47 9h meta #1071513

The Problem

I have been here a while, and have grown very fond of SN. Whether it's logical or not, I am very invested in seeing it grow and prosper. I have written and read many posts like this in the past, asking for this or that innovation or improvement. Some eventually are implemented. Some aren't. Some have been promised, but we're still waiting.

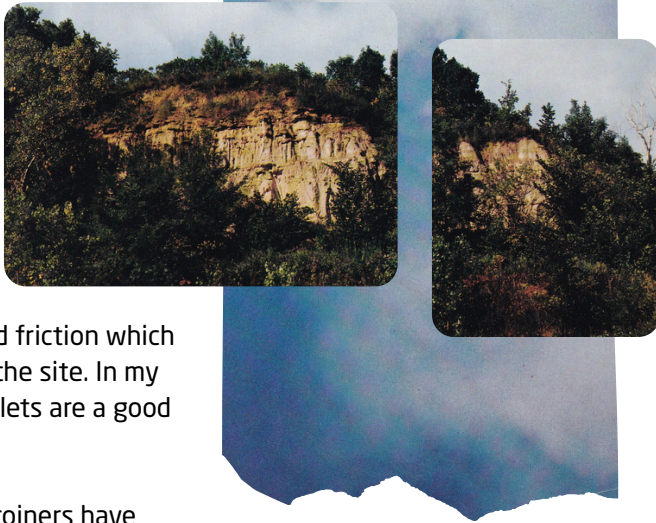
SN was sidetracked as a result of potential legal problems which forced a change to non-custodial wallets. It took a lot of work. Many stackers left. Others are still complaining.

There's no doubt it created friction which has hampered growth of the site. In my opinion, non-custodial wallets are a good thing in the long run.

Meanwhile, prominent bitcoiners have shunned or openly attacked SN for whatever reason. There's not much that can be done about that.

Territories were a big innovation. They seemed so promising. They were rolled out a few months before the Samurai bullshit. They were losing propositions from day one. I don't blame @k00b and company for that. The timing was unfortunate, and they've done a hell of a job making a huge transition.

As a founder of four territories, I know the frustration. Lately, though, I'm feeling that I am also responsible for the slow growth of my territories. Rather than wait around for some magic innovation that makes them profitable, maybe I should take a different approach. I will leave the marketing of SN to the founders, and spread the word in a more decentralized way.



The @grayruby Way

If you have been around for a while, you might remember that @grayruby started Stacker Sports before territories even existed. He didn't wait around or ask permission. He started posting his sports posts right in the meta territory, if I recall. When territories became available, he hit the ground running. He had a plan and a vision, which paid off. I'm pretty sure he's just getting started. Now of course we all can't be him. He's a smart, motivated guy with good ideas and plenty of motivation. That doesn't mean we shouldn't use him as a model.

@2grayruby is generous, both by zapping posts in his territory and creating an environment where sports fans can succeed on their own. It's good business, sure, but it also spreads sats around and will eventually teach sports fans about bitcoin. He will prosper, his best territory posters will prosper, Stacker News will eventually prosper, and bitcoin adoption will grow.

Territories represent specific interests. I have been one of those clamoring for sub territories, but considering the size of SN right now, they don't make sense. Rather, I think founders should encourage posters to claim their own piece of existing territories. Here's where individual interests and passions can come into play.

My Harebrained Idea

...

SCAN TO KEEP READING

